

DAN BLACK DIGITAL

INFORMATION MANAGEMENT & BIM ADVISORY

Business Plan and Course Outline

Working draft, July 2026

1. Executive Summary

Dan Black Digital is an Information Management and BIM advisory business serving the UK construction industry. The business operates across two channels: a Kajabi platform selling online courses, templates, and productised resources, and a standalone website generating bespoke consulting engagements. The founder, Dan Black, brings direct cross functional experience in sales, quantity surveying, Revit modelling, BIM management, and Golden Thread/information management work, giving the brand credibility across the full project lifecycle rather than a single discipline.

The core offer covers ISO 19650 compliant Information Management, Common Data Environment (CDE) setup and governance, Building Safety Act and Golden Thread compliance, and general BIM practice. Revenue comes from three streams: digital products (courses and templates on Kajabi), consulting services (booked through the main website), and, longer term, potential subscription or membership products.

2. Business Overview

Business name: Dan Black Digital

Founder: Dan Black

Sector: Construction, Built Environment, Information Management, BIM

Platforms: Kajabi (courses, templates, products), standalone website (brand, consulting, lead generation), LinkedIn (authority building, outreach)

Mission: to make Information Management and BIM compliance understandable and achievable for construction professionals and organisations, through practical courses, ready to use templates, and expert consulting.

Vision: to become a recognised, trusted name in Information Management advisory for construction, known for practical, no nonsense guidance rather than generic theory.

3. Market Analysis

Industry context

- The Building Safety Act 2022 and the Golden Thread requirement, which mandates accurate, accessible building safety information across the lifecycle of higher risk buildings
- ISO 19650 adoption as the standard framework for managing information over the whole life of a built asset using BIM
- Growing client side demand for demonstrable CDE governance, particularly on public sector and regulated projects
- A persistent skills gap: many organisations know they need to comply but lack in house expertise to set up CDEs, write EIRs/BEPs, or manage a Golden Thread properly

Target audience

- Information Managers and BIM Managers seeking upskilling or reference templates
- Project Managers, Quantity Surveyors, and Design Managers who need to understand Information Management without becoming specialists
- Small and mid sized contractors and consultancies without a dedicated Information Management function
- Duty Holders and Principal Contractors under the Building Safety Act needing practical Golden Thread guidance
- Individuals studying for or transitioning into BIM/Information Management roles

Competitive landscape

The market includes larger established consultancies offering high end advisory, and a smaller number of individual trainers and course creators offering ISO 19650 or BIM training online. There is limited competition specifically combining productised courses/templates with bespoke consulting under one personal brand, positioned around practical, real world delivery rather than pure theory. This is the gap Dan Black Digital is aiming to fill.

4. Products and Services

A. Digital products (Kajabi)

Courses:

- ISO 19650 Foundations: an introduction to Information Management for BIM, aimed at professionals new to the standard
- CDE Setup and Governance: practical guidance on building and running a compliant Common Data Environment
- Golden Thread and the Building Safety Act: what it means in practice for Duty Holders, Principal Contractors, and Principal Designers
- Information Management for Non BIM Professionals: aimed at PMs, Qs, and client teams needing working knowledge without full technical depth
- Writing Effective EIRs and BEPs
- Safety Case Reports: approach and content for regulated higher risk buildings

Templates and products:

- EIR (Exchange Information Requirements) template pack
- BEP (BIM Execution Plan) template
- MIDP/TIDP tracker
- Asset Information Model (AIM) checklist
- Golden Thread compliance checklist
- CDE workflow and governance model diagrams
- RACI matrix for Information Management roles
- Safety Case Report template

B. Consulting services (via main website)

- CDE audits and setup for organisations without in house capability
- Golden Thread readiness assessments for Duty Holders
- EIR/BEP review and drafting support
- Information Management strategy for individual projects or across a portfolio
- Ad hoc advisory retainers for ongoing support

C. Potential future products

- A subscription template library (recurring revenue, low maintenance once built)
- Cohort based courses with live Q&A, priced at a premium over self paced courses
- Corporate/team licences for courses
- Speaking, webinars, or a newsletter to build the top of funnel

5. Revenue Model and Pricing Considerations

Product type	Price range (indicative)	Notes
Individual template	£15 to £45	Low friction entry point, builds email list
Template bundle/pack	£75 to £150	Higher perceived value, easier upsell
Self paced course	£150 to £400	Core Kajabi revenue driver
Cohort course with live support	£500 to £1,200	Premium, limited cohorts, higher touch
Consulting day rate	Benchmark against market rate	Set a rate that reflects your experience and positions you as a credible specialist
Retainer	Monthly fixed fee	Best suited to organisations with continuous compliance needs

6. Marketing and Brand Strategy

LinkedIn

- Regular posts breaking down Golden Thread, CDE, or BIM concepts in plain English
- Case study style posts (anonymised) drawing on real project experience
- Commentary on regulatory changes (Building Safety Act updates, ISO revisions)
- Roughly 80 percent value led content, 20 percent promotion

Website

- Positioned as your professional shopfront: credibility, case studies, service descriptions, and a route into consulting enquiries
- Should link out clearly to Kajabi for anyone wanting to self serve via courses or templates
- SEO focused blog content targeting search terms like Golden Thread compliance, CDE setup, ISO 19650 explained

Email

- Capture emails through free or low cost template downloads
- Nurture sequence introducing your background, then guiding toward paid products
- Regular newsletter covering industry updates

Other channels to consider

- Industry webinars or partnerships with training providers, professional bodies (CIOB, RICS, BSI), or software vendors
- Guest appearances on construction/BIM podcasts
- Speaking at industry events once the brand is established

7. Operations

Platforms

- Kajabi: hosts courses, templates, checkout, and student area
- Website (WordPress, in progress): brand presence, consulting enquiries, blog, links to Kajabi
- LinkedIn: outreach, content, authority building

Tools likely needed

- Email marketing (often built into Kajabi, or a separate tool for more control)
- Calendar booking tool for consulting enquiries
- Invoicing and accounting software
- Contract/proposal templates for consulting engagements
- Cloud storage for template masters and course materials

Time allocation

Be realistic about capacity, especially in the early stages. A simple split to consider: content creation and course/template development in defined blocks, consulting delivery scheduled around other commitments, and marketing/LinkedIn as a small, consistent habit rather than sporadic bursts.

8. Legal and Administrative Setup

Business structure

Decide between sole trader and limited company. A limited company is generally preferred for a consultancy: it separates personal and business liability, looks more credible to corporate clients, and has tax planning advantages once profits grow, though it comes with more admin (annual accounts, Companies House filings). Register the company name with Companies House once confirmed, and check it doesn't clash with an existing registered name.

Contracts and terms

- Terms and conditions for Kajabi product sales (refund policy, licence terms for templates, usage rights)
- A standard consulting services agreement/contract for client engagements, covering scope, fees, payment terms, liability, and confidentiality
- A privacy policy and cookie policy for the website (required under UK GDPR)

Insurance

Professional indemnity insurance is strongly advisable for any advisory work, particularly given the compliance/safety critical nature of Golden Thread and Building Safety Act guidance. Public liability insurance if you ever run in person training or events.

Tax and finance

- Register for Self Assessment (sole trader) or Corporation Tax (limited company) with HMRC
- Consider VAT registration thresholds if turnover is expected to approach the current threshold
- Set up a separate business bank account
- Use accounting software (Xero, QuickBooks, FreeAgent) from day one
- Budget for an accountant, at least for annual accounts and tax filing

Intellectual property

Course content, templates, and branding are your core assets. Keep clear records of ownership as the catalogue grows. Consider trademarking Dan Black Digital once confirmed, particularly the logo and name, to protect it as the brand grows.

9. Financial Plan

Item	Estimated cost
Kajabi subscription	£100 to £300 per month depending on tier
Website hosting and domain	£100 to £300 per year
Company formation (Companies House)	£50 to £100
Accountant (annual)	£500 to £1,500
Professional indemnity insurance	£300 to £800 per year
Branding/logo/design	£0 (in progress) to £500 if outsourced further
Course production (design tools, video equipment if needed)	£0 to £500
Marketing/content tools	£0 to £50 per month

Map fixed monthly costs (Kajabi, hosting, tools) against your lowest cost product to understand how many sales are needed per month to cover overheads before profit begins. Keep starting costs low and lean on free or low cost tools until revenue is consistent.

10. Risks and Mitigations

Risk	Mitigation
Slow initial traction (common for new course businesses)	Build email list and LinkedIn audience before full launch, use free templates as lead magnets
Regulatory content becoming outdated (Building Safety Act, ISO updates)	Build in a regular review cycle for course and template content
Time capacity conflict with other commitments	Realistic scheduling, phased launch rather than everything at once
Liability from advisory content (compliance heavy sector)	Professional indemnity insurance, clear disclaimers on templates and courses stating they are guidance, not a substitute for formal compliance sign off
Brand/name clash with existing businesses	Final Companies House and domain check before public launch

11. Suggested Roadmap (First 90 Days)

Weeks 1 to 2

- Finalise business name and confirm no clashes (Companies House, domain, trademark search)
- Register company structure (sole trader or limited company)

Weeks 3 to 6

- Finalise brand identity (logo, colours, tone of voice)
- Build out website core pages (home, about, services, contact)
- Set up Kajabi account structure and first product

Weeks 7 to 10

- Launch LinkedIn presence under the new brand, begin regular content
- Build an email capture mechanism (free template or mini guide)
- Draft consulting services agreement and pricing

Weeks 11 to 13

- Soft launch first paid product on Kajabi
- Begin outreach for first consulting enquiries via LinkedIn and website
- Review early feedback and adjust pricing/positioning before scaling the product catalogue

12. Open Decisions Still Outstanding

- Final confirmation of business name (Dan Black Digital, pending final availability checks)
- Sole trader vs limited company decision
- First product to launch (recommend picking one, not building the whole catalogue before revenue validation)
- Pricing for consulting day rate

13. Example Course Outline: ISO 19650 Explained

Positioning: aimed at people new to Information Management, BIM Managers early in their career, or PMs/QSs who need to actually understand ISO 19650. Self paced, no prerequisites.

Format: 5 modules, video lessons of 8 to 15 minutes each, a downloadable PDF summary per module, a short quiz at the end of each module, and a template pack bundled in or offered as an upsell.

Module 1: Why ISO 19650 Exists

- The problem it solves (information loss, poor collaboration, inconsistent data across a project)
- Brief history: from BS 1192 and PAS 1192 to ISO 19650
- Who it applies to and when

Module 2: The Core Concepts

- Information Management as a discipline, not just software
- Key terms: AIM, PIM, EIR, BEP, CDE, MIDP, TIDP, explained simply
- How these pieces fit together across a project lifecycle

Module 3: The Common Data Environment (CDE)

- What a CDE actually is and isn't
- The four states: Work in Progress, Shared, Published, Archive
- Common mistakes organisations make when setting one up

Module 4: Roles and Responsibilities

- Appointing party vs lead appointed party vs appointed parties
- The Information Manager role in practice
- How RACI style responsibility mapping supports this

Module 5: Applying It in Practice

- A worked example project (anonymised, based on real experience)
- How EIRs and BEPs come together
- Common pitfalls and how to avoid them
- Where to go next, natural point to introduce deeper courses

Supporting materials

- A glossary PDF of every term used, useful as a free lead magnet on its own
- A one page ISO 19650 at a glance diagram
- Quiz questions per module for completion tracking

Pricing consideration

As a foundational, broad audience course, this sits well in the £150 to £250 range as a self paced course, potentially with the glossary or one template offered free to drive sign ups before people commit to buying.